

Workstation window, switch to your virtual machine's tab and click on "Exit Unity" and the virtual machine will be back in its tab! In addition to the symbol on the title bar of virtual machine windows, you also get a colored border around them which look more like an aura.

- ▶ **Encryption:** Encryption is a feature which allows you to password-protect your virtual machine. This includes its virtual hard disk file, the snapshots and the configuration files. You'll need a password to encrypt and decrypt the virtual machine, even if you're copying it to another machine. Although this is available as a feature, we don't recommend using it unless you have really sensitive data on the machine which you don't want anyone else to have an access to.

This feature doesn't come recommended for a few reasons:

- The performance of an encrypted virtual machine is noticeably lower than that of a normal one.
- You require the password to use it. If you tend to forget passwords, beware!
- In case something goes wrong during encryption, such as a power failure, you're at a loss. Imagine your configuration files encrypted and hard disk files unencrypted. Chaos.

If you really need to protect the data, it would be better to enable protection of the data inside your virtual machine (for example, enabling NTFS encryption on your Windows guest machine). Use this feature only when you're sure about what you're doing and having made sure to the best of your knowledge that nothing would go wrong when trying to use it.

- ▶ **Autologon:** This feature allows you to supply the guest username and password to VMware Workstation to which you want to log on when you switch on the guest. Although it's useful, we'd rather prefer using the guest OS for doing this job.
- ▶ **Guest Isolation:** This feature allows you to seamlessly copy files from your guest OS to your host OS by dragging and dropping. You can also do a [Ctrl+C] in your guest and [Ctrl+V] in your host or vice versa. This is what we were talking about when we mentioned bi-directional clipboards in a previous chapter. Dragging and dropping files to copy between guest and host is an immensely useful feature which only VMware Workstation supports among other desktop virtualization programs. Use it and you'll come to know why it's so useful.
- ▶ **Shared Folders:** This feature, as mentioned before allows you to make use of your folders / directories on your host OS in the guest OS. Work-